Student Absence Tracker

Journal of how the app was built and developed

47	75	4820	34
development phases	published changes	lines in the main page	files in the project

From October 9, 2026 to November 8, 2026

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About the app

An Arabic (right-to-left) web app for recording student absences period by period on a weekly sheet, shared live by the school's offices, with statistics, notifications to parents, a make-up list and a French version.

It was built over successive conversations with the person in charge of the app: they ask for an addition or a change, it is implemented, tested and published to both sites, then the result is reviewed and a new improvement is requested. This file tells those phases in chronological order.

Technical architecture

Part	Description
Front end	A single HTML file with plain JavaScript (no framework), an fr.js file for instant French translation, and sw.js so the page works offline
Server	Vercel functions in the api folder (accounts, saving the sheet, statistics history, school-year archive)
Storage	Upstash Redis, with a KEY_PREFIX key prefix that isolates each school's data
Deployment	Two Vercel projects from the same repository (Al-Mothabara Private Institution, and Al-Mothabara Private Primary School), deployed automatically on every push to main
Testing	Dozens of automated Playwright browser tests (recording absences, printing, permissions, weeks, offline work, statistics, import…) run before every release

Timeline

Date	Phase
2026-09-30	1. Foundation: the shared absence sheet
2026-10-01	2. Accounts and permissions
2026-10-02	3. Several schools, first statistics, a logo per school
2026-10-03	4. Deeper statistics and confirmation before recording
2026-10-04	5. Semi-automatic notifications to parents
2026-10-05	6. Recording and correction safeguards
2026-10-06	7. Number of periods per school timetable
2026-10-07	8. The big day: logo, approvals, French, colours
2026-10-08	9. Make-up list and hardening “Add a student”
2026-10-09	10. Notifications restricted to the administrator
2026-10-10	11. Working offline and the week buttons
2026-10-13	12. Timing per class, header order and the school year
2026-10-14	13. Importing the teaching organisation from Excel
2026-10-15	14. Absence sheet: pinned columns, bottom rows, the bar and dragging the table
2026-10-17	15. Justification inside the absence cell and its breakdown in the statistics
2026-10-17	16. Mid-term holiday week: a locked sheet
2026-10-17	17. “Teacher” account records absences at roll call
2026-10-18	18. Importing a list without losing absences, and backups of the sheet
2026-10-18	19. Changing the “from” date shows that week's data at once
2026-10-18	20. Training pack: demo site and fictional Excel files
2026-10-18	21. “Nobody” for the teacher, and teachers working without internet
2026-10-19	22. Removal of the icon home screen
2026-10-23	23. Inviting teachers by e-mail: a ready account with one click on the link
2026-10-23	24. Row number pinned beside the names when moving between days
2026-10-24	25. Setting up e-mail sending on Vercel and tolerance for spaces in the Gmail password
2026-10-24	26. Phone: the days of the week stacked, moving between them by scrolling down
2026-10-24	27. Day bar on the computer version, and pinned columns in French

2026-10-24	28. Current week for everyone, no recording after the period ends, and the narrow strip hidden
2026-10-24	29. Delete and selection columns hidden; edit or delete a student by tapping the name
2026-10-24	30. Wider absence cells on the phone
2026-10-24	31. Training site published on Vercel
2026-10-25	32. The day bar also shows during the holiday week
2026-11-05	33. “مسؤول(ة)” instead of “مسؤول” in the interface
2026-11-05	34. “Message to a parent” button for writing to parents about things other than absences
2026-11-05	35. Choosing a WhatsApp group in the “Message to a parent” window
2026-11-05	36. WhatsApp group names specific to each institution
2026-11-05	37. 2026/2027 inter-term holidays from the official list
2026-11-05	38. “Holiday” day feature: single-day holidays
2026-11-06	39. Week-by-week navigation and a monthly absence sheet for one student
2026-11-07	40. Fix for importing the “educational organisation” file of the primary school
2026-11-07	41. Protecting the absences of past weeks when moving between weeks
2026-11-08	42. Clearer and faster indicator for pending account requests
2026-11-08	43. Statistics kept up to date when classes are renamed, and a tool to delete mistaken absences from the archive
2026-11-08	44. “Top of page” and “Bottom of page” buttons on the phone version
2026-11-08	45. A livelier look: title in a nicer font and vividly coloured buttons
2026-11-08	46. Simpler button colours: four colours, one meaning each
2026-11-08	47. “☰ Menu” dropdown gathering the sections of the app (desktop and phone)

Development phases in detail

1 Foundation: the shared absence sheet

2026-09-30

Request: A weekly sheet where every office records student absences and all other offices see them instantly, without a computer acting as a server.

- Weekly table: five days × morning and afternoon periods, a tab per class, and a student list with the parent's phone number.
- Columns for subject and teacher, and totals of absence hours (per period, per day, per week).
- Parent notification through a ready-made WhatsApp message, and printing of the class sheet with the school header and logo.
- Import of a student list from an Excel file (choosing the names column and the header row from a preview).
- Shared storage on Vercel and Upstash Redis with periodic synchronisation between offices, protected by a single password.

Technical notes: First commit: index.html (about 940 lines), api/state.js and package.json.

2 Accounts and permissions

2026-10-01

Request: A single administrator who edits, and view-only accounts that browse without changing anything, instead of one shared password.

- Login with email and password; the administrator is the email set in the server settings and cannot be registered through the public form.
- View-only accounts are read-only: writing is refused by the server itself (403) however the buttons are shown in the browser.

Technical notes: Signed sessions (HMAC-SHA256) valid for 30 days, and passwords stored as salted scrypt hashes. New files: api/auth.js, api/_lib.js and api/_seed.js.

3 Several schools, first statistics, a logo per school

2026-10-02

Request: Use the same code for more than one school with separate data, and see absence figures instead of just the table.

- The KEY_PREFIX, INSTITUTION_NAME and SEED_BLANK variables: each Vercel project gets its own data, accounts and name.
- Statistics page: total absence hours, number of absent students and their rate by day, week and month, per class or level, with printing.
- Weekly archive: on every save a summary of the week is stored on the server (api/history.js), so past weeks stay available and the sheet itself does not grow.
- A logo specific to each school (LOGO_FILE) with a layout for wide logos.

Technical notes: api/_stats.js summarises the week and derives the level from the class name (1AIPC-2 → 1AIPC).

4 Deeper statistics and confirmation before recording

2026-10-03

Request: Richer reports for the administration, and protecting the sheet from a wrong click.

- A per-student view, class and level filters, and charts that are included when printing.
- Export of charts as PNG images and of the table to Excel.
- Every recording or deletion of an absence asks for confirmation that names the student, the class and the period.

Technical notes: About 290 lines for the statistics, and a change to how clicking a cell behaves.

5 Semi-automatic notifications to parents

2026-10-04

Request: Inform parents of absences without anyone counting hours by hand.

- One hour of absence → a notice to the parent; three hours → a summons to come to school.
- The count is cumulative over the month (archived weeks plus the current sheet), and what was already sent is remembered so it is not repeated.
- The message is prepared as ready text in WhatsApp and the administrator only has to press “Send”.

Technical notes: Fully automatic sending needs a paid service provider, so WhatsApp with one click by the administrator was chosen.

6 Recording and correction safeguards

2026-10-05

Request: Prevent common mistakes and correct what was recorded by error.

- An absence cannot be recorded for a period whose time has not come yet, and upcoming cells look different.
- A button to go back to the previous week to correct a mistaken absence; on save, that week's summary in the statistics is updated automatically.
- The days and periods rows stay visible while scrolling the student list, and are repeated at the bottom of the table.

Technical notes: The finished week is kept in full (absences, subjects and teachers) in state.other so it comes back exactly as it was.

7 Number of periods per school timetable

2026-10-06

Request: Fit the table to schools that differ in how many periods they have.

- Add or remove a period in the morning and in the afternoon; subjects, teachers, absences and period times are realigned so nothing slips into a wrong period.
- Archived weeks keep their own layout, so their figures stay correct.

Technical notes: state.pc = [morning periods, afternoon periods], stored with every weekly summary.

8 The big day: logo, approvals, French, colours

2026-10-07

Request: Let the school manage itself and extend use to French-speaking users.

- The administrator changes the school logo from the app; it is stored on the server and shown on every device.
- New view-only accounts wait for the administrator's approval (the “Approve a new account” button).
- The French version: language switching within the same page and left-to-right direction, covering WhatsApp messages, printing, charts and Excel (the fr.js file).
- The interface is named “Student Absence Tracker”, and so is the browser tab.
- A thick separator between morning and afternoon and after each day in the table and in print, and a colour layer (day colours, coloured buttons and the week bar).
- Buttons rearranged: the tabs row below the buttons, and list import next to “Add a student”.

Technical notes: fr.js is a translator that runs at runtime: a dictionary for fixed phrases and patterns for sentences with numbers, plus a page observer that translates whatever is added to it.

9 Make-up list and hardening “Add a student”

2026-10-08

Request: Let the support team schedule make-up sessions, and deal with a complaint about the “Add a student” button.

- “Make-up list”: absent students and the subjects they missed (from the weekly archive), with Excel export.
- Telling parents the date, time and place of the make-up session through WhatsApp, which also works for view-only accounts.
- “Add a student” button: the cursor stays in the name field, a warning for an empty name, readiness for the next name, and preventing local storage or an old poll from cancelling the save.

Technical notes: The fault could not be reproduced on our side, so a preventive hardening was added, then the user confirmed that everything works.

10 Notifications restricted to the administrator

2026-10-09

Request: View-only accounts must not send absence notices or summonses.

- The automatic-notice and summons panels and their send buttons are shown to the administrator only.
- A clearer frame around the new student's name field.

Technical notes: Make-up session notices remain available to view-only accounts, as requested earlier.

11 Working offline and the week buttons

2026-10-10

Request: Keep recording absences when the network drops, and simplify moving between weeks.

- Unsent edits are kept on the device and sent automatically when the connection returns; the page opens without internet, with a bar showing the status and a warning window if another administrator edited in the meantime.
- The week buttons sit under the two date fields and are named “Previous” and “Next”, and the “Current week” button comes before the date on its row.

Technical notes: A copy of the sheet in localStorage with “unsent” and “copy base” markers; sw.js caches only the page shell and never caches /api. A test showed that edits were being erased when the connection returned, so the design was corrected.

12 Timing per class, header order and the school year

2026-10-13

Request: Finer detail per class, then a whole school year that can be archived.

- Period times per class, and a class without settings follows the default times.
- Header order: “Logo” before “Current week”, and “Log out” at the end of the first row.
- The school year appears at the top of the page (inferred from the date or edited by the administrator).
- “Archive the season” moves all weeks' absences into the season archive and starts the statistics from zero in the next season, keeping the lists and subjects.
- A “Season” selector in the statistics to browse archived seasons (read, print and export), and deleting them is for the administrator.
- The “Archive the season” button sits under the table next to “Add a student”.

Technical notes: api/season.js: each week is stored in its own field in Redis, and archiving a season twice is prevented. Two corrections for our misunderstanding of two requests: the “Change season” button was meant to name the season, not to archive it.

13 Importing the teaching organisation from Excel

2026-10-14

Request: Stop typing the subject and teacher name by hand for each period of each class.

- The “Import teaching organisation” button reads the “teaching organisation” file: teacher blocks (code → teacher + subject), the classes table and the “timetable for class” sheets.
- A window decides, for each class in the file, which class it applies to (match by name, create a new class, or ignore).
- Spelling mistakes are corrected from the class table, and names are cleaned of elongation characters and repeated spaces.
- Student lists and absences are not changed.

Technical notes: Tried on the real file: 6 classes, 15 teachers and 28 periods per class, using a substitute Excel reader in the test because downloading the real reader is blocked in the development environment.

14 Absence sheet: pinned columns, bottom rows, the bar and dragging the table

2026-10-15

Request: The phone column disappeared when moving between days of the week, unlike the names column. Then a request to move the table left and right by long-click and drag. Then the “Add a student”, “Import list from Excel” and “Archive the season” buttons were to stay visible while the table moves, with the archive button at the far left of the row. Then the “absence count per period” and “days of the week and periods” rows below the list were to stay visible too. Finally the “subjects” and “teachers” row was to be pinned as well.

- The “Parent's phone” column stays visible next to the names column while the sheet scrolls horizontally between days.
- The two column headings (“Full name” and “Parent's phone”) stay visible as well.
- Moving the table with the mouse: a long left-click then drag left or right (and up/down), with the cursor turning into a grabbing hand.
- Dragging never records an absence by mistake; a normal click opens the confirmation window as usual, and typing in the phone fields and the buttons is unaffected.
- The add bar (new student's name + the three buttons) is now fixed at the bottom of the table and stays visible however the table is moved sideways or the list scrolls down.
- The “Archive the season” button is at the far left of the row, and the bar wraps onto two lines on narrow screens.
- The “absence count per period” row and the “days of the week and periods” rows below the list are now pinned directly above the add bar, and stay visible while moving around the table or the names and phones list.
- The subjects and teachers row is now pinned under the days and periods rows at the top of the table while going down the list.

Technical notes: position:sticky for the phone column with an offset equal to the names column width, measured after every table render (the --namew variable), so it is correct with long names. Dragging: mousedown, mousemove and mouseup events with a 5-pixel threshold, and the click following a drag is cancelled (touch is unaffected since it already scrolls). The bar sits inside a wide wrapper with position:sticky (bottom and right) whose width equals the visible area (the --hostw variable). The heights of the pinned rows are measured after every render (the --b0, --b1 and --b2 variables) so they stack from the bottom. The three top headings stack by measuring their heights (--hr1 and --hr12), and the pinned label cells cover only the name and phone columns so they do not hide periods on narrow screens.

15 Justification inside the absence cell and its breakdown in the statistics

2026-10-17

Request: A “justified or unjustified” choice is more useful if added in the absence-recording cell itself, next to “A”. (It was first tried as a per-student column before the phone, then the column was removed and this solution adopted.) Then a breakdown of justified and unjustified absences in the statistics was requested.

- Clicking an empty cell makes the confirmation window ask: “Record unjustified absence” or “Record justified absence”.
- An unjustified absence shows a red “A” as before, a justified one shows “A” with a small “J” in green, and a tooltip explains the state on mouse hover.
- Clicking a recorded absence lets you delete it or switch it between justified and unjustified without notifying the parent again.
- A justified absence counts in the counters and statistics like any other, and is saved in the weekly history, so it comes back as it was when returning to the previous week.
- In print it appears as a small “J” above the “A”, and in the French version as “absence justifiée / non justifiée”.
- Main cards: under “Absence hours (today)” and “Total absence this week” two badges: how many hours are unjustified and how many justified; and under “Absence by subject / teacher” the phrase “of which n justified”.
- Statistics window (day / week / month, by class / level / student): two new columns “of which justified” and “of which unjustified” after “Absence hours”, in the table, in print and in the Excel export.

Technical notes: The cell value became true (unjustified) or 'j' (justified), so every calculation built on truthiness stays correct. In the server's weekly summary (api/_stats.js) there is a digit per period: 0 present, 1 absent, 2 justified absence. The server's weekly summary carries a colsJ array (justified per period) next to cols; weeks saved before the feature are counted as entirely unjustified.

16 Mid-term holiday week: a locked sheet

2026-10-17

Request: The week of 19 to 23 October 2026 is a mid-term holiday: it stays locked, nothing can be recorded, and a prominent “Mid-term holiday” text appears across the days of the week.

- When this week is shown, the absence cells are hidden and replaced by large hatched blocks reading “Mid-term holiday” above each half-day (morning / afternoon); the subject and teacher cells are locked and clicking opens no window.
- The locked week does not enter the statistics (its summary is not saved and it does not count as a recorded day), and moving on from it with “Next” does not replace the real “previous week”.
- Printing shows the same wording instead of the cells; the French version reads “Vacances intermédiaires”.
- Incidental fix: printing a sheet containing a justified absence used to break, and was corrected.

Technical notes: The list of weeks is in state.breaks (from / to / label), with a default value in the interface and in api/_stats.js (summarizeState returns empty for the holiday week). There is no screen yet to edit the list, so adding another holiday is done by editing the data.

17 “Teacher” account records absences at roll call

2026-10-17

Request: Trial of giving the teacher permission to record absences at roll call at the start of the period, without being able to edit the rest of the sheet.

- A third role next to administrator and view-only: the administrator turns any approved account into a “teacher” from the accounts window, with an optional teacher name as it appears in the table, and withdraws the permission with one button.
- The teacher sees the sheet read-only, but the absence cells become clickable in today's periods whose time has started: one tap records the absence with no questions, and a tap on a recorded absence asks to confirm deletion. If a name is saved, the teacher is limited to their own periods.
- The teacher interface is simplified for the phone: only the season, the week date, the class tabs bar, the class table with its students' names, an “Add a student” button, the language switch and logout; statistics, printing, make-up, import, approval, parent notifications, phone columns and deletion are hidden; the language and logout buttons are on one line on a phone screen.
- The teacher adds a student by name only through the server (which refuses duplicates and empty names), and cannot delete or edit; parents' phone numbers are never sent to them by the server.
- A justified absence is the administrator's decision alone, so the teacher neither creates nor removes it, and sees no edit buttons or parent notifications.
- The server enforces all of this (today's date in Casablanca time, the period has started, not a holiday week, matching the student's name and place), and saving the whole sheet stays for the administrator only.
- Two simultaneous roll calls by two teachers do not lose one another, because the server locks reading and writing the sheet; this was tested with six parallel requests.
- The French version of all new texts and messages.
- Both cases verified: a teacher account with no saved name records in any period that has started today, and an account with a saved name records only in their own periods. Name matching now tolerates a different order, titles, spellings of alef, ya and ta marbuta, and accented Latin letters, with the same rule on the server and the page.
- When a teacher taps a locked cell a message explains why (weekend, sheet on a past week, another day, period not started, another teacher's period with both names, justified absence), in Arabic and French, instead of leaving the cell silent.

Technical notes: A new endpoint api/mark.js edits a single cell inside the stored sheet (read then write under a Redis SET NX lock). The role is saved in the account record and overrides what is in the signed token (refreshed within a minute). A known limit: if the administrator saves an old sheet at the very same moment it could overwrite a teacher's roll call, so the server uses the same lock and the

administrator's page resynchronises on its first poll. api/mark.js adds the addstudent action, api/state.js returns parents' phones empty for a teacher account, and hiding in the interface uses the body.tch class.

18 Importing a list without losing absences, and backups of the sheet

2026-10-18

Request: Importing a list that was almost the same as the existing one wiped the week's absences and the phone numbers. Needed: that it never happens again, and a way to recover what gets lost.

- Import now has three buttons: “Update the list keeping absences and phones” (first), “Add”, and “Replace”, which now asks for an explicit confirmation stating how many absences and phones will be erased.
- The update matches names word by word regardless of order and of differences in how alef, ya and ta marbuta are written, and accepts a difference of one or two letters when it is not ambiguous; whoever is in both the file and the list keeps their absences and phone, and the administrator is asked about those not in the file (delete them or keep them). “Add” no longer duplicates an existing name.
- Automatic backups on the server before any save that loses absences, phones or students in one go, and at most every 12 hours, keeping the last 15 copies.
- A “Backups” button for the administrator: list the copies, save one immediately, and restore partially (absences and phones for the students of the current list, matched by name) or fully; every restore first saves a copy so it can be undone.
- Incidental fix: confirmation messages now appear above the import window instead of hiding beneath it.
- The French version of all new texts.

Technical notes: api/_backup.js (snapshot on loss or periodically, the index, restore by matching) and api/backups.js under the same lock used by api/state.js. The snapshot is taken in POST /api/state after reading the stored state. What was lost before this addition has no copy in the app; what may exist in Upstash backups or in the weekly statistics archive (for previous weeks only) remains.

19 Changing the “from” date shows that week's data at once

2026-10-18

Request: When the week's start date is changed in the “from” field and Enter is pressed, the table's data changes to match the chosen week instead of only relabelling it.

- If the new date is within the same week (the same Monday) only the label changes and the data stays.
- If it is in another week, the current week is saved first and then the chosen week is shown: in full (absences, subjects and teachers) if it is the other week kept in the sheet, otherwise rebuilt from the statistics history (absent students, subjects and teachers). The week that was displayed stays saved, so typing its date again restores it in full.
- The mid-term holiday week opens directly, locked.
- For a week with no data the administrator is asked to choose: show an empty week at this date, or change the date only while keeping the current data, or cancel (the old date returns). An empty or invalid date restores the previous one.
- An empty future week is not added to the statistics archive (so the statistics do not fill up with empty weeks).
- The French version of the new texts.

Technical notes: jumpToWeek and archivedWeekAt in index.html (using state.other, snapshotWeek, applyWeek and ntLoad), and a guard in archiveWeek in api/_stats.js that skips a week which has not started yet and has no absences. A new Playwright test covers: a previous week, going back, the same week, a week with no data (3 buttons), the holiday week, an empty date, and the server state.

20 Training pack: demo site and fictional Excel files

2026-10-18

Request: Make a training course on the app possible with a demo site and a completely fictional school, without touching any real school’s data or using real names.

- New run mode: SEED_DEMO in the Vercel settings. Value 1 starts with an empty timetable that trainees fill in by importing; value 2 starts with a ready timetable. On the first visit the “Al-Ofoq (demo)” school is created: 6 classes, 121 students with invented names and invented phones (starting with 06000), an empty current week and four past weeks of invented absences on the statistics page.
- The setting only acts when the database is empty, so it cannot change the data of an existing project; the demo site is kept apart from the others by its own KEY_PREFIX.
- Three fictional Excel files (docs/training): student lists (one sheet per class), an updated version (one student leaves each class, newcomers join, alphabetical order) for the “update while keeping absences and phones” exercise, and a fictional “educational organisation” file (class grid with lesson codes, timetable with subjects, blocks for the fifteen teachers) with no teacher in two classes at once.
- The two generators (export.js and build-xlsx.py) read the same data as the server, so the files and the demo site always agree.
- README guide in docs/training: creating the training Vercel project, resetting after each course, answer key for the exercises and a table of the fictional teachers.

Technical notes: File api/_demo.js (deterministic data, fixed-seed random generator, timetable built by random search with no teacher clashes) and a modified GET in api/state.js (set with NX, then the weeks written to history). Playwright tests with a stub Excel reader: seeding, importing the educational organisation (result identical to the SEED_DEMO=2 timetable, lesson by lesson) and importing the updated list (absences and phones kept even though positions changed).

21 “Nobody” for the teacher, and teachers working without internet

2026-10-18

Request: Let the administration check that the teacher did the roll call even when nobody is absent, and keep absence recording working when the teacher’s internet goes down.

- A “Nobody” (لا أحد) button under each period for the teacher: pressed when the roll call is done and nobody is absent, it records the teacher’s name and the time on the sheet. One tap plus a confirmation cancels it; it cancels itself if an absence is later recorded in that period, and it is refused if an absence is already there. The rules are those of recording an absence: today’s period, already started, and the teacher’s own.
- A second “✅ Nobody” button in the add-student bar for the teacher: it acts on their period in progress in the class (the latest started period of today that is theirs) and asks for a confirmation naming the class, period and subject; for the administrator, the “✅ Roll-call follow-up” button after “Import a list from Excel”.
- Follow-up for the administration: under each period’s absence count, a ✓ (roll call done with “Nobody”) or a red “!” (no absence and no “Nobody” 20 minutes after the period began); the “✅ Roll-call follow-up” button lists the periods without a recorded roll call (class, period, subject, teacher) and the “Nobody” declarations with their time, for today or the whole week. It covers the current week and periods that have a subject or a teacher.
- Teachers working without internet: the app opens on the device where the teacher has already signed in (account, name and last sheet are kept) and they record absences and “Nobody” as usual; each tap shows at once with an orange dashed frame (“waiting”), the status bar shows how many are unsent, and everything is then sent automatically, in order, when the network returns.
- Deferred records carry the time of the tap: the server checks “today” and “period started” against that time rather than the arrival time (and refuses a future time or one older than 18 hours). Whatever the server refuses on arrival (an absence justified in the meantime, a new week, a student removed from the list) is reported to the teacher with the student, the period and the reason, and the screen returns to the server’s copy. If the session expires, the records stay and are sent after signing in again with the same account; the “Log out” button warns when some remain.
- Complete French interface for these additions, and the README updated (the “teacher account” and “working without internet” sections used to say the teacher needs internet).

Technical notes: In api/mark.js: a new action 'called' storing columns[i].called={at,by}, a shared teacherRules function for the teacher’s rules, an optional at field with tapTime (18-hour ceiling, future refused), and the marker removed when an absence is recorded. In index.html: a local queue ghiyab_tq (operations carry absolute values so a resend is harmless; the last tap on a cell replaces earlier ones), a

tqOverlay layer re-applied over every server copy so automatic sync never erases what is not yet sent, tqFlush sending in order and stopping on a dropout or 5xx, dropping refusals for good (409 stale retried three times), and the teacher’s name kept in USER_KEY so the app opens offline with their rights. Tests: 28 server checks (rules and times) and a browser test with simulated dropout, page reload with no network, automatic sending, refusal on arrival and the logout warning, plus a French test checking that no Arabic text is left on screen.

22 Removal of the icon home screen

2026-10-19

Request: Withdraw a trial that did not help users.

- A home screen of icon tiles (17 tiles for the administrator) was tried and then removed at the administrator’s request: most tiles opened the same interface as before and added nothing. The interface is back as it was: the app opens straight on the sheet and the statistics, catch-up and other buttons are where they were, with no effect on the server or the data.

Technical notes: Undone with git revert of the home-screen commit (index.html, fr.js, README).

23 Inviting teachers by e-mail: a ready account with one click on the link

2026-10-23

Request: So that teachers no longer wait for an approval: they receive a link by e-mail and their account becomes a teacher account as soon as they open it, while the “Approve a new account” button stays for unknown people who registered themselves.

- In the “Approve a new account” window, an “Invite teachers” box: one line per teacher (the e-mail, then the name as in the timetable, optional) and a “Send the invitations” button that handles several lines at once and skips duplicates. Below it, the “Invitations waiting” list with “Resend” and “Cancel”.
- The link is random, valid for 7 days and works once. The teacher opens it and the “Activate the teacher account” page shows the locked e-mail; they choose a password (at least 8 characters) and go straight in with an approved teacher account (tied to their name if the administration entered it). If the link is opened again or has expired, the ordinary login page appears with the reason.
- The e-mail goes out through any SMTP account (for example Gmail with an app password), set with Vercel variables, without any external library. If nothing is configured or sending fails, the window shows the link with “Copy the link” and “WhatsApp” so the administrator sends it themselves: the feature always works, e-mail is only a convenience.
- Security: only the SHA-256 of the link is stored; activation can be used once even with two simultaneous requests; an account request filed by someone who does not own the address is removed at invitation time (or its password is replaced by the link holder's); the link never changes the password of an already approved account; attempts are limited per IP address; the SMTP password never travels over an unencrypted connection. An already approved account is simply promoted to teacher by the invitation, with no link.
- Complete French translation (window, activation page, messages) and a fix in fr.js: text typed into a text area stays as typed but its hint (placeholder) is now translated. README updated with the “Inviting teachers by e-mail” section and the Gmail setup.

Technical notes: New file api/_mail.js (a small SMTP client on net and tls: direct TLS on 465 or STARTTLS on 587, AUTH PLAIN/LOGIN, base64 multipart MIME message with UTF-8 headers, 9 s timeout). In api/_lib.js, the invitation helpers (loadInvite, hashToken, keys <KEY_PREFIX>:inv:<hash> with a 7-day ex and <KEY_PREFIX>:invites as the administrator's index). In api/users.js, the invite and uninvite actions and the invites and mail fields in GET ?all=1; in api/auth.js, the accept action (the token is consumed with DEL and only the request that really deleted it goes on) and GET ?invite=. In index.html, the invite mode of the login screen and invParse/invSend/invShow. Tests: 40 server checks (including simultaneous use and address squatting), 14 for the mail client against a fake SMTP server in its three modes, and interface checks in Arabic and French at phone width.

24 Row number pinned beside the names when moving between days

2026-10-23

Request: When the sheet was moved sideways towards the days of the week, the name column stayed in place but the student number (column «۩») disappeared, so the student's rank in the list was lost. The number must stay visible in front of every name however the sheet is moved.

- The «۩» column is now pinned beside the name column (then the parent phone column for the administrator), on computer, on phone and for the teacher account; its header and the total cell at the bottom stay pinned with it.
- The selection and delete columns (administrator) still scroll away, so they do not shrink the room for the days on a phone screen, and come back when returning to the start of the sheet.
- The numbering itself never changes from one day to another: it is the student's rank in the class list, unrelated to the days or the absences.

Technical notes: In index.html, td.num is pinned with position:sticky and an --oNum offset; the offsets of the pinned columns (۩, name, phone) are measured cumulatively in syncHeaderOffset and stored in --oNum, --oName and --oPh, replacing the old --namew; a lead class is added to the empty cells under «۩» in the header and footer. New test (pintest) with an automated browser: after scrolling the sheet to its end, the positions of ۩, the name and the phone do not move, on computer, on phone and with a teacher account.

25 Setting up e-mail sending on Vercel and tolerance for spaces in the Gmail password

2026-10-24

Request: Set the e-mail variables of the two Vercel projects to try a real teacher invitation, and deal with what showed up on the first try.

- The variables SMTP_HOST, SMTP_USER, SMTP_FROM and PUBLIC_URL were added from the Vercel dashboard in both projects (sending address collegealmotabara@gmail.com, each project's link in PUBLIC_URL).
- On the first try the message "e-mail not configured" appeared because the password had been saved under the name SMPT_PASS instead of SMTP_PASS; then Gmail refused with code 535 5.7.8 (BadCredentials), so the app password value itself was not accepted, and one of the two projects still carried the wrong name.
- Because Google shows the app password as four groups separated by spaces, the server now removes spaces and line breaks from SMTP_PASS, with Gmail only, and the README points out the exact variable name.

Technical notes: In api/_mail.js: when SMTP_HOST ends with gmail.com or googlemail.com the password is cleaned with replace(/\s+/g,''). The configuration function is exported as _config for the test. The 14 mail-client tests still pass, with an extra check of the cleaning for Gmail and of no change for other servers.

26 Phone: the days of the week stacked, moving between them by scrolling down

2026-10-24

Request: On a phone, going from one day of the absence week to another meant scrolling the sheet sideways through dozens of columns. Navigation should be vertical, the way pages are browsed on a phone.

- On narrow screens (700 pixels or less) the app shows one section for each of the five days, with a small table holding the student number and name and that day's morning and afternoon periods; the next day is reached by scrolling down, with no sideways scrolling at all.
- A bar of days stays at the top of the sheet: tapping a day name jumps to it, and the current day (when it falls in the week shown) is highlighted with a filled chip and a "today" badge.
- Every day has its "number of absences per period" row (with the teacher's "nobody" mark and the administrator's follow-up) and a collapsible "Subjects and teachers" section to read, and for the administrator edit, the subject and teacher of each period.
- At the bottom of the page a "Student list and parents' phones" section (for the administrator and the read-only viewer, not the teacher) holds selection, deletion and the parent's number, which keeps the day columns narrow.
- Recording, deleting and converting an absence work as before (same confirmation window), the page keeps its scroll position after each recording, the wide screen goes back to the usual sheet when the window is enlarged or the phone is rotated, and all the new texts are translated into French.

Technical notes: In index.html: cellHtml and addBarHtml are extracted from renderTable so both layouts share them; renderTableVertical is called when matchMedia matches max-width: 700px (with a change listener); vJump jumps to the chosen day; CSS classes vday/vnav/vscroll/vt/vfoot/vmeta. The column numbers (data-ci) are the same, so toggleCell, teacherMark, callMark and setMeta work unchanged. Four new sentences in fr.js. New test (verttest) on a virtual phone: five sections and five day buttons, no sideways scrolling in any section or in the page, an absence recorded in the right column with the scroll kept, editing a subject and a phone, return to the wide sheet, French with no Arabic left over, viewer and teacher accounts.

27 Day bar on the computer version, and pinned columns in French

2026-10-24

Request: The user liked the day bar of the phone layout (tapping a day name jumps to it) and asked for it on the computer version too, to make moving between the days of the week easier.

- A bar of five buttons (Monday to Friday), in the days' own colours, is added above the wide sheet; a click slides the sheet sideways until the first column of that day sits right against the pinned number, name and phone columns, and the current day is highlighted when it is in the week shown.
- The bar works for the administrator, the viewer and the teacher; it is hidden on a phone (which has its own bar between the stacked days) and during an inter-term break.
- On the way it turned out that pinning the number, name and phone columns did not work in the French (left-to-right) interface except for the name; this is fixed: the three columns stay in place in that language too, and the bar works in both directions.

Technical notes: In index.html: a dayNav element above tableHost, and the functions renderDayNav, hJump and todayDay (shared with the vertical layout); hJump computes the width of the pinned block from the --oPh/--oName variables and the column width, subtracts border and padding according to the direction, then calls scrollBy. In fr.js, CSS rules move the pinned columns' offsets to the left in the left-to-right direction. New test (navtest): position of the days after each click in Arabic, in French and with a teacher account, at two computer widths, the bar disappearing on a phone and coming back when enlarged, and the three columns staying put in French.

28 Current week for everyone, no recording after the period ends, and the narrow strip hidden

2026-10-24

Request: The administrator browsing other weeks changed the shared sheet, so teachers and viewers saw the same week and teachers could no longer record. They were to keep the current week at all times; the teacher may read the absences of every day of the week but record only in the current week, in his own period and before it ends; and a narrow strip showing at the table edge was to be hidden.

- Users other than the administrator no longer follow his browsing: when the sheet shows another week and the week that contains today's date is kept aside (state.other), that one is shown to the teacher and the viewer, in a local copy from which nothing is written back. Whatever the administrator does (past week, next week, a week from the archive) changes nothing for them.
- A teacher's recording (absence or “Nobody”) always goes to the current week wherever it is kept, even while the administrator looks at another week; period numbers are converted to that week's layout when the number of periods differs, a student missing from its saved copy is added to it, and the statistics are updated for the right week. The administrator always works on the sheet in front of him.
- New rule: a teacher can no longer record, change or remove an absence or a “Nobody” after his period has ended. End of period = start + one hour, or the start of the next period of the same half-day if that comes sooner. The moment of the tap is what counts, so a tap made during the period without internet is accepted when it arrives later. The cell is locked on screen when the period ends and the message shown when it is tapped explains why (in Arabic and French).
- The teacher still reads the recorded absences of every day of the current week, and records only in today's periods.
- The narrow strip (about 14 pixels) at the edge of the wide sheet, where column edges showed while passing under the pinned columns, is hidden by removing the sheet's side padding: the pinned columns now touch the edge (Arabic and French).

Technical notes: In api/mark.js: frameFor (picks, between the sheet and state.other, the week that contains today and converts the column number), otherClass, otherRow, archiveView, endMinutes and PERIOD_MIN; teacherRules was rewritten to take this frame and adds the period_over refusal. In index.html: snapshotWeekOf and applyWeekTo (the swap logic moved into them), liveView (applied to what the server sends to non-administrators), colEnd, colIsOver and PERIOD_MIN, changes to teacherWhy, teacherMark and refreshFutureCells, removal of the side padding of #tableHost. In fr.js: three translations. New test livetest (32 checks) and the teacher tests updated to send the time of the tap.

29 Delete and selection columns hidden; edit or delete a student by tapping the name

2026-10-24

Request: The delete-button (×) column was to be hidden from the list, with deletion offered only after clicking a student's name, together with the option of editing the name. It was then asked to drop the selection-checkbox column that sat before the numbering column as well.

- The “×” button column is removed from the wide sheet and from the phone list.
- The selection-checkbox column (and the “Delete selected” bulk deletion that depended on it) is removed from the wide sheet and from the phone list, so the list now starts with the numbering column; the number of columns of the “absence count” and “days and periods” rows at the bottom of the sheet is corrected to match the remaining columns.
- Clicking a student's name (administrator only) opens a small dialog with the editable name and the buttons “Save name”, “Delete student” (with confirmation) and “Cancel”. An empty, too long or duplicate name in the class is refused, and spaces are normalised.
- Renaming keeps the student's absences and phone; the week kept aside and the notices already sent (matched by name) follow the new name. Note: weeks already archived in the statistics keep the old name.

Technical notes: In index.html: functions studentDialog and renameStudent, removal of the dl column in renderTable and in the renderTableVertical list, an editable class on the name cell. In fr.js: six translations. New test studenttest (34 checks: computer, phone, French). Removal of the selection column, the bulk-delete button and the selection functions.

30 Wider absence cells on the phone

2026-10-24

Request: The absence cells of the phone layout looked a little narrow; it was asked to widen them, even by making the names column slightly smaller.

- The absence cell in the phone layout is now about 34 to 37 pixels wide (27 before) and 41 tall (27 before), so it is easier to tap with a finger, and the “ع” letter is larger.
- The name column goes from 104 to 72 pixels (a long name wraps onto two or three lines) and the number column to 20 pixels; the table with its six periods therefore fits a 360-pixel screen with no sideways scrolling; with more periods or a narrower screen a slight sideways scroll appears.

Technical notes: In index.html: CSS rules of #tableHost.vert table.vt (td.num, td.name, th.nmh, td.cell, th.per) only, with no change of data or logic.

31 Training site published on Vercel

2026-10-24

Request: Back to the fictional institution with invented data meant for training sessions, already ready in the code (phase 20) but with no published site.

- A third Vercel project, “ghiyab-training”, is created and linked to the same repository (it updates with every application update), at ghiyab-training.vercel.app, without Vercel login protection so trainees can open it directly.
- It is configured with KEY_PREFIX=training (training data kept apart), SEED_DEMO=1 (an empty timetable the trainees fill by importing the educational-organisation file) and a randomly generated SESSION_SECRET. The fictional content was re-checked automatically: 6 classes, 121 students, four past weeks with invented absences and no teacher in two classes at once.
- Left to the user: the training administrator's password (ADMIN_PASSWORD) and connecting the Upstash database to the project, then a redeploy; this is explained in docs/training/README.md.

Technical notes: Project creation and deployment through the Vercel MCP; no change to the application code.

32 The day bar also shows during the holiday week

2026-10-25

Request: The row of day buttons (Monday to Friday) did not appear on the computer layout for the week of 19-23 October, because it was hidden during the inter-term holiday; the feature seemed to exist only on the training site.

- The bar now shows in a holiday week too: the day columns are there and tapping a day works as in other weeks.
- It stays hidden only when the timetable has no periods (no column to jump to) and on a phone (which has its own bar inside the sheet).

Technical notes: In index.html: the breakNow() condition is removed from renderDayNav; the holiday table draws the same day headers, so hJump finds the th.day.d cell it needs.

33 “مسؤول(ة)” instead of “مسؤول” in the interface

2026-11-05

Request: The user asked for the word “مسؤول” to be written in a form covering both masculine and feminine.

- Every occurrence of the word in the interface becomes “مسؤول(ة)” (account badge, login page texts, messages to teachers such as “أخبروا المسؤول(ة)”, server messages); roles and permissions are unchanged.
- The French translation is aligned (exact keys and regular expressions) and the role badge reads “Administrateur(trice)” in French.

Technical notes: Text replacement of the word in index.html, api/auth.js, api/mark.js, api/users.js and api/backups.js, and in the keys and rules of fr.js (parentheses escaped in the regular expressions).

34 “Message to a parent” button for writing to parents about things other than absences

2026-11-05

Request: The administrator asked to be able to message a pupil’s parent on WhatsApp about something other than absences, such as neglected homework or poor discipline in class.

- A “💬 Message to a parent” button is added to the button bar under the list, before “Archive the season”; it is for the administrator account only.
- The window lets you choose the class, the pupil and the topic (neglected homework, lack of discipline in class, another topic); a ready-made text that can be edited is filled in, then “Send via WhatsApp” opens the chat with the parent’s number and the message ready. The number comes from the list; it can be typed or corrected, with the option to save it in the class list.
- Text and interface in Arabic and French; nothing is stored on the server.

Technical notes: In index.html: parentMsgOverlay element and functions parentMsgOpen, parentMsgFillStudents, parentMsgRefill, parentMsgSend and parentMsgText, wa.me link via normalizePhone; in fr.js: the window’s keys. Tested in a browser in both languages (button order, link, saving the number).

35 Choosing a WhatsApp group in the “Message to a parent” window

2026-11-05

Request: The administrator created WhatsApp groups for the parents of each level (1st, 2nd and 3rd year of middle school) and asked for them to be added to the class list of the “Message to a parent” window.

- The “Class or group” list now offers three groups after the classes: 1st, 2nd and 3rd year of middle school. When a group is chosen, the pupil and phone fields disappear and a general text for that level’s parents (homework, discipline or another topic) is filled in, editable.
- WhatsApp cannot pre-fill a message inside a group, so the “Copy the message and open the group” button copies the text and opens the group through its invitation link for pasting. The invitation link is pasted once and stays saved in the shared sheet.
- The group links do not reach teacher and read-only accounts: the server removes them from the sheet it returns to anyone but the administrator.

Technical notes: In index.html: state.parentGroups field ([{name,link}]) and functions pmGroups, parentGroupText, parentGroupSend and pmCopy (copy by execCommand then clipboard), link checked against chat.whatsapp.com; in api/state.js: parentGroups removed from the reply for non-administrators; in fr.js: the interface keys. Tested in a browser (list, hidden fields, link, copy, saving, French).

36 WhatsApp group names specific to each institution

2026-11-05

Request: The primary school’s parent groups differ from the middle school’s, so the group names were to be removed from the primary version (to be supplied later) and kept on the training site.

- Group names are now read from the PARENT_GROUPS variable of each institution’s project: not set = the three default groups (middle school and training site), “-” = no groups, comma-separated names = that institution’s list.
- The value “-” is set in the primary project (marjaiya-ghiyab): no group shows there until the names are supplied, after which they only need to go into the variable followed by a redeploy; the three groups remain on the training site and the middle school.
- Saved invitation links are tied to the group name, so changing the list does not mix the links up.

Technical notes: In api/config.js: envGroups returns groups in the GET reply; in index.html: pmGroups takes the names from PM_NAMES (filled by applyBranding) or else the default list, and gathers the links from state.parentGroups by name.

37 2026/2027 inter-term holidays from the official list

2026-11-05

Request: The administrator supplied the official school holiday list for 2026/2027 (primary, middle and high school); the application only knew the first holiday period.

- The locked weeks (a “holiday” block replaces the cells, outside the statistics, no absence can be recorded) are now five: the week of 19 October 2026 (1st period), of 7 December 2026 (2nd), of 25 January 2027 (mid-year holiday), of 22 March 2027 (3rd) and of 10 May 2027 (4th).
- The training site is unaffected (its holiday list is empty on purpose); one-day holidays (national and religious feasts) are not added because they do not lock a whole week.

Technical notes: DEFAULT_BREAKS updated in index.html and api/_stats.js (also used by api/mark.js), and the French translation of “عطلة منتصف السنة الدراسية” added in fr.js. Tested on 14 week starts: the five are locked, the weeks before and after are open.

38 “Holiday” day feature: single-day holidays

2026-11-05

Request: The administrator asked for a “holiday” day to see how useful it is in practice; national and religious feasts fall on a single day without locking a whole week, and the application left their cells open for entry.

- New “🏖️ Holidays” button (administrator only) opens a dialog listing the days: add (date, label, number of consecutive days up to 14), delete, and restore the default list.
- The default list holds the 2026/2027 national holidays from the official list; religious feasts (Eid al-Fitr, Eid al-Adha…) depend on the moon sighting and are added by hand.
- A holiday shows on desktop as one block with its label covering all its periods, on phone as a banner instead of the day table, and in print as a block too.
- No absence can be recorded on it: the server refuses the tap from the administrator and the teacher alike (error holiday) with a clear message, the teacher sees the reason when tapping the cell; statistics and totals ignore that day.
- Adding a holiday that has recorded absences in the displayed week asks for confirmation, then clears those absences.
- The training site has an empty list on purpose; the interface is translated into French, default feast names included.

Technical notes: state.holidays field in the shared state, with DEFAULT_HOLIDAYS and holidayOn in index.html and api/_stats.js, holidayBlock in api/mark.js, table display with colspan/rowspan, holidays added to api/state.js and api/_demo.js, translations in fr.js. Tested in a local browser: 17 checks (server refusal for the administrator, the teacher and “Nobody”, normal day accepted, statistics ignore it, dialog, delete and consecutive days, French, phone banners), all passed; not yet tried on the published site.

39 Week-by-week navigation and a monthly absence sheet for one student

2026-11-06

Request: The administrator asked for the “Previous”, “Next” and “Current week” buttons to be reviewed so that going back to any week since the start of October is smooth and logical, and for printing a monthly absence sheet for a single student. “Previous” showed only one week before the current one and then stopped; an older week needed the date to be typed.

- “Previous” goes back week after week to the start of the season (the week containing 1 October, or the oldest week with an absence) and is disabled at that limit.
- “Next”, while a past week is shown, moves forward one week until the current week is reached; on the current week it keeps its role: start a new week.
- “Current week” returns straight from any week, and the yellow banner shows how far the displayed week is from the current one (for example: 2 weeks before the current week).
- The dates of an absence week are always Monday to Friday: “From” is the Monday and “To” the Friday of the same week at every navigation (Previous, Next, new week, typed date), and a week saved with other dates is corrected automatically (the dates used to drift when navigating); the “To” field only accepts the Friday.
- Core fix: the current week stays kept in state.other throughout the navigation and is no longer replaced when moving from one past week to another, so the way back is never lost and the teachers' live view carries on.
- New “🖨️ Student sheet” button: a dialog to choose the class, student and month with a summary line (hours, days, justified and unjustified), then a printed A4 sheet in Arabic or French: totals, a table of days with period, subject, teacher and justification status, a remarks box and signatures of the administrator and the parent.
- Holidays and holiday weeks are not counted on the sheet; the interface and the sheet are translated into French.
- Printing the weekly sheet now always fits on a single A4 landscape page: 7 mm margins, the table is scaled down automatically as much as needed to fit in width and height (large classes used to run onto two pages or lose columns), names without wrapping and smaller cell padding.
- At the bottom of the weekly sheet print, a “Teacher's signature after the roll call and the recording of absences” row in the table itself, with a tall empty cell (about 20 mm) under each column (period), roomy enough for a signature, where that period's teacher signs (holiday cells are merged), and an “Administration stamp” box at the bottom of the page; all within the single page.
- The student rows of the weekly sheet print are shaded alternately: 1st, 3rd, 5th… in light grey, 2nd, 4th… unshaded, to the end of the list (the holiday block keeps its colour).

- Redesign of the weekly sheet print to fill the A4 landscape page: fixed-width columns and wider absence cells, larger fonts (name, “غ” mark, headings), subject and teacher written vertically above each column, student row height adapted to their number to use the available page (the table is only scaled down for very large classes); the “Administration stamp” box became a cell at the end of the signature row instead of a separate box, saving page height.
- Narrower student-name column in the print (from about 204 to 150 px) to widen the absence cells, and the “Friday afternoon” column removed from the print for good (only Friday morning is printed; the table in the app and its data are unchanged).

Technical notes: goPrevWeek, goNextWeek, weekStep and weekFloor in index.html above jumpToWeek with keepOther, a modified renderWeekNav, ssSources, ssCollect, stuSheetOpen and stuSheetPrint (archive plus the sheet on screen and state.other), snapWeekDates and showWeekDates to fix Monday–Friday, a rewrite of the weekly print in triggerPrint (table-layout:fixed, fitOnePage for row height and fonts then scaling down when needed) and translations in fr.js. Tested in a local browser: navigation between weeks (33 checks passed) and printing with 8, 30, 45 and 70 students in Arabic and French (always one A4 landscape page, with no scaling for a class of 30); not yet tried on the published site.

40 Fix for importing the “educational organisation” file of the primary school

2026-11-07

Request: Importing the primary school's educational-organisation file showed the message “The class timetable (days and hours) with the subject codes was not found in the file” although the file was fine.

- Cause: the day headings of the class grid are written per half-day (“Monday morning”, “Monday afternoon”…) while the import only accepted the bare day name, and the lesson times use several dashes (“10:25----09:00”) while it accepted only one; so it found the 9 teachers but no class.
- The import now accepts the day name followed by the half-day (morning or afternoon) and one or several dashes (or a long dash) between the start and end time of a lesson.
- Tried on the school's file: 9 classes found (1APG to 6APG2), 9 teachers and 18 filled lessons per class, with subject and teacher (4 days of 4 lessons, Friday morning 2 lessons).
- In the “Import educational organisation” window, the file's class “1APG” is suggested automatically for the only existing class whose name starts with it (for example “1APG1”) instead of creating a new class; the administrator can still change the choice.

Technical notes: orgDayIdx, ORG_DAYS, orgPeriodCols (dash expression), parseOrgWorkbook and orgRender in index.html. The reading function was tested in Node on the data of the school's Excel file (before the fix: 0 classes, after: 9 classes × 18 lessons); the import window has not yet been tried on the published site.

41 Protecting the absences of past weeks when moving between weeks

2026-11-07

Request: The administrator asked that recorded absences no longer be lost when moving between absence weeks, after the absences of October and the first week of November disappeared.

- A hole found in review: a past week shown on the sheet is rebuilt from the archive and matched to the current students by name, then saving it overwrites that week's archive. If a student had been deleted or renamed, the list replaced or the class deleted, their absences were lost from the archive for good because they do not appear on the sheet.
- When it saves a past week, the server now keeps in the archive the absences of every student whose name is not in the class's current list and of every class no longer on the sheet, and recomputes that week's totals; correcting the absence of a student who is in the list applies as before.
- The current week is not affected (renaming a student there does not duplicate their absences), and absences of a week deleted entirely before this fix do not come back.
- Tested locally: without the protection the archived week's absences are lost (7 failing checks); with it they stay complete (rows, totals, days, deleted class) and correcting a listed student still works; the week-navigation test (33 checks) still passes.

Technical notes: keepOrphans and archiveWeek in api/_stats.js (called by api/state.js on every save). Only archive rows with the same number of columns (same number of periods) are merged.

42 Clearer and faster indicator for pending account requests

2026-11-08

Request: The administrator created an external account from the login page and did not see the “account awaiting approval” indicator, and the approval button seemed not to work.

- Full check on a local copy: signing up an external account, its appearance under “👥 Approve a new account”, accepting it and logging in all work; but the indicator was a small number refreshed when the page opened and then only every minute, so it did not show for someone waiting in front of the open page.
- The indicator now reads “1 pending”, refreshes every 20 seconds and at once when the administrator comes back to the page or the browser window; the button is coloured and pulses gently, and the count appears in the browser tab title “(1) Student Absence Tracker”; the accounts-list request is no longer cached by the browser.
- French translation: “1 en attente”.
- Note: each site (primary, middle school, demo) has its own account database; a request created on one site does not appear on another.

Technical notes: usersBadge, usersRefreshCount, usersFetch and startApp in index.html, the CSS rule #usersBtn.attn and a line in fr.js. Tested with a full scenario (sign-up, indicator, acceptance, login, indicator appearing by itself after 14 seconds, French) on a local copy.

43 Statistics kept up to date when classes are renamed, and a tool to delete mistaken absences from the archive

2026-11-08

Request: The statistics kept the old class names after they were renamed, and an old absence recorded by mistake showed in the statistics but not in the table, with no way to delete it.

- Cause: the statistics read a weekly archive keyed by class name, and renaming a class only changed the table; the archive kept the old name and classes appeared twice in the statistics.
- Renaming a class now moves its absences in all archived weeks to the new name (merging them if a class of that name exists in a week), together with its custom level and the week kept aside (state.other), whose absences were lost on returning to the current week.
- “🧹 Old classes in the archive no longer in the table” panel in the statistics: for each old name, its number of weeks and absences, with “Transfer” to a current class or “Delete from all weeks” (to handle what is left from past renames).
- “🧹 Correct this week's absences” panel in the “weekly” view of an archived week: list of the classes and students with absences, with “✖ Delete his/her absences” for a student or “Delete all the class's absences this week”; the week's totals are recomputed.
- Administrator only and without effect on the current week (corrected in the table); with French translation.

Technical notes: POST /api/history (rename, removeClass, removeStudent), editHistory, recountClass and mergeClassSnap in api/_stats.js and api/history.js; renameClass, svCleanHtml, svBindClean and svEdit in index.html; fr.js translations. Tested with a full scenario on a local copy (13 checks: transfer, merge, deletion, recount, rename from the table, refusal of a non-administrator).

44 “Top of page” and “Bottom of page” buttons on the phone version

2026-11-08

Request: The administrator asked for two buttons on the left side of the phone version to jump quickly to the top and the bottom of the page.

- Two fixed round buttons on the left edge (▲ top of page, ▼ bottom of page) on screens 700 px wide or less, above the other buttons and below the pop-up windows.
- A button dims when the page is already at the end it leads to; it updates on scrolling and as the page grows while the table and the statistics load.
- Hidden on the login page, on desktop and in print; smooth scrolling except for people who prefer reduced motion on their device; French labels: “Haut de la page” and “Bas de la page”.

Technical notes: pageScroll, scrollNavUpdate, showApp and the .scrollnav rules in index.html, two lines in fr.js. Tested on a simulated phone (390 px): display, position, scrolling to both ends, disabled state, French, absence on desktop and on the login page.

45 A livelier look: title in a nicer font and vividly coloured buttons

2026-11-08

Request: The administrator asked for the app title in a nicer font in magenta-purple, and for nice fonts and vivid colours on all buttons.

- Title in the “Lalezar” font in a solid magenta (red-purple), in the app and on the login page (the gradient to violet was removed at the administrator’s request).
- All buttons in the clear, bold “Cairo” font with vivid gradients and a light shadow: blue, turquoise, green, orange, purple, red and pink, each function having its own colour; delete and logout buttons in red.
- Class buttons (tabs) with a violet outline, the selected class in a magenta → violet gradient; the top/bottom-of-page buttons use the same gradient.
- A dark version consistent with night mode; the day-navigation buttons keep their colours; printed sheets are unchanged.

Technical notes: Google Fonts link (Cairo and Lalezar) and a CSS block in index.html with the variables --f-ui, --f-title, --t1, --t2, linear-gradient and color-mix. Tested on desktop and phone in light and dark mode (no horizontal scroll, no leftover dark-green button); the real fonts could not be previewed because the test environment blocks the internet.

46 Simpler button colours: four colours, one meaning each

2026-11-08

Request: The administrator noticed that too many different colours on the buttons confuse users, and asked for the colours and fonts to be reorganised so the app is easier to control.

- Buttons now use only four colours, each with a fixed meaning: blue for viewing and moving around (current, previous and next week, statistics, catch-up list, call follow-up, message to a parent), violet for settings (logo, number of lessons, school timetable import, lesson times, holidays, backups, season archive, list import, account approval), green for doing (print, export, send, save, add) and red for leaving and deleting.
- A blue-grey for close, back and language buttons, so they do not compete with the important ones.
- The bold “Cairo” font in the same size everywhere; the app title and the class tabs stay in magenta, and the pending-accounts button pulses pink when a new request arrives.

Technical notes: Per-id --bc rules at the end of the last CSS block of index.html (blue #1E6FD9, violet #7C3AED, green #0F8A52, red #E0245E, grey #5B6B7F); the same gradients serve dark mode. Tested on desktop and phone in light and dark mode with no horizontal scroll; the navigation and print tests stay green.

47 “☰ Menu” dropdown gathering the sections of the app (desktop and phone)

2026-11-08

Request: The administrator asked for a dropdown menu, on desktop and on phone, containing the tabs of the application to make it easier to control.

- A “☰ Menu” button on desktop at the far right, before the institution’s logo; on the phone, beside the title on the same line, with an extra round ☰ button among the floating buttons on the left, always within reach while scrolling; both are removed on the phone for a teacher account, where the menu is not useful (it stays on desktop).
- The menu is split, using the button colours, into four groups: Browse (absence sheet, statistics, catch-up list, call follow-up, message to a parent, previous, current and next week), Settings (lessons, school timetable import, lesson times, holidays, list import, logo, backups, season archive, account approval), Printing, and Account (language and logout).
- Each entry first goes back to the absence sheet and then runs the original button’s function, so you can go from the statistics to any setting in two taps; the page being shown is highlighted; only the entries allowed for the account appear (a teacher or a read-only account sees fewer).
- The menu closes by tapping outside or with the Esc key, can be driven with the ▲▼ arrow keys, and ☰ pulses pink when an account is waiting for approval; the menu is fully translated into French.

Technical notes: MENU_GROUPS, menuBuild, menuToggle and menuGo in index.html, the #appMenu element and a few translation lines in fr.js. The menu reads the state of the original buttons when it opens, so nothing needs maintaining when permissions change. Tested on desktop, phone (390 px) and in French: 39 checks (opening, position inside the screen, going to statistics, catch-up and the sheet, opening a settings dialog from the statistics, closing with Esc and by clicking outside, no page errors).

Working method

1. Every change is built first in a local test copy, and its tests are run together with the old tests before release.
2. Permissions never rely on hiding buttons alone: every write is checked by the server.
3. The archive does not enlarge the sheet that is polled every second and a half: separate summaries are kept on the server.
4. The French translation covers every new text (dictionary + sentence patterns) and is checked by a test.
5. When a request is ambiguous (such as where a button goes), the closest understanding is implemented, then corrected according to the user's feedback, and the reading that was understood is stated.

Still open

- Delete the old Vercel domains by hand (up to the user).
- Try “Archive the season” for the first time at the real end of the season, because clearing absences from the table cannot be undone.
- Try the teaching-organisation import on the live site with the real Excel reader.
- Try the teacher account in a real lesson: is a single tap without confirmation appropriate, and must the account be linked to the teacher's name in every account? Also try the “Nobody” button (is the 20-minute delay before the “!” right?) and working without internet in a room with no coverage.
- Try restoring from “Backups” on real data, and enable the daily backup in Upstash if the plan allows it.
- Set up e-mail sending (SMTP) on Vercel and try a real invitation to a teacher, checking that the message lands in the inbox and not in spam.
- Try the end-of-period rule in a real lesson: is a one-hour period (or until the next one starts) right for your school, or must the length be adjustable in “Period times”?
- Finish setting up the training site (ADMIN_PASSWORD and Upstash connection) and try a complete session on it with a teacher account and a viewer account.

Appendix: change log

Hash	Date	Change
2dd4224	2026-10-09	Absence notices and summons to parents: administrator only (read-only accounts no longer see the panels or send buttons)
d737ab4	2026-10-09	Add-student name box: clearer border and focus ring
a776f6f	2026-10-10	Work without internet: unsent edits are kept on the device and sent automatically on reconnect; page opens offline (service worker); conflict prompt; offline status banner
81edcd4	2026-10-10	Week buttons («الأسبوع الماضي» and «أسبوع جديد») directly under the week date fields
acf865f	2026-10-10	Rename week buttons to السابق / التالي and add الأسبوع الجاري button beside the dates
a1a9e21	2026-10-10	Move logo button above the current-week button; wrap week controls on narrow screens
322fe74	2026-10-13	Per-section period start times; logo button on the same line before the current-week button
a65c26f	2026-10-13	Header: logout button ends the first row (after the user name), other buttons start a new row, as in the French layout
18fb65e	2026-10-13	School year: show the season and archive the annual absence (api/season.js, archive button, season picker in statistics)
7e4bd4c	2026-10-13	Toolbar: season archive button goes last in the row
77a8e2a	2026-10-13	Season label at the end of the subtitle line; archive button back between periods and times
af9d148	2026-10-13	Move the season archive button under the table, next to add-student and import
9206a40	2026-10-14	Import the teaching organisation (subject + teacher per section) from the Excel timetable file
d6414b5	2026-10-14	Add development journal PDF (auto-generated from docs/journal.json) and update rule
e42b138	2026-10-15	Keep the phone column visible beside the name column when scrolling between days
d522640	2026-10-15	Drag the attendance sheet sideways with the mouse (click and drag)
10fef07	2026-10-15	Keep the add/import/archive bar pinned while moving the sheet; archive button at the far left
732da02	2026-10-15	Pin the absence-count row and the days/periods rows above the add bar
af91154	2026-10-15	Keep the subjects/teachers row pinned under the days and periods rows
16309fb	2026-10-15	Development journal PDF: use Latin digits only
998ac5d	2026-10-17	Add a justified / unjustified toggle in front of each parent's phone number
94bf6be	2026-10-17	Remove the per-student justified/unjustified column (replaced by a per-absence marker)
f5bb051	2026-10-17	Justified / unjustified absence inside the attendance cell (غ red, م+غ green)
9d28d47	2026-10-17	Statistics: detail justified / unjustified absences (cards, tables, exports)
7c4adc2	2026-10-17	Lock the inter-term holiday week (19-23 Oct 2026): show 'عطلة بينية', keep it out of the statistics; fix printing a justified absence
42b76bd	2026-10-17	Teacher accounts: record absences at roll call (server-enforced via /api/mark: today, started period, own name, no justified); admin grants it from the accounts dialog
3ddf135	2026-10-17	Teacher view: simplified mobile layout (season, week dates, class tabs, sheet, add student, language, logout), add-student for teachers via /api/mark, parents' phones hidden from

		teacher state
452c155	2026-10-17	Teacher phone header: language and logout buttons on one line
7eb5f8e	2026-10-17	Teacher name matching: tolerant of word order, titles, alef/ya/ta-marbuta spellings and Latin accents (same rule on server and page)
17efc57	2026-10-17	Docs: teacher name matching rules, journal
3755430	2026-10-17	Teacher: explain why a locked cell cannot be recorded (weekend, stale week, other day, not started, not your period, justified); server message names both teacher names
2537074	2026-10-18	Import keeps absences and phones for matching names (sync/append/replace with confirmation); automatic server snapshots before data-losing saves, with partial/full restore dialog
e9fb3e2	2026-10-18	Week date: typing a new 'from' date + Enter shows that week's data (kept/archived/blank/holiday); empty future week not archived; docs, journal PDF
6e5584c	2026-10-18	Development journal PDF in French and English (builder renders ar/fr/en from journal.json + translations); rules updated
8608c19	2026-10-18	Training pack: SEED_DEMO demo site, fictional student lists and educational-organisation Excel files
65a2472	2026-10-18	Teacher roll call «لا أحد» with admin follow-up, and teacher work without internet (local queue, auto-send, tap-time rules)
50c45c7	2026-10-18	button in the add-student bar for teachers (current period, with confirmation); «لا أحد» follow-up button after the import button for the admin
9b9d905	2026-10-19	Home screen with colourful icon tiles for the administrator and read-only accounts (teachers keep going straight to the sheet)
ad45f16	2026-10-19	Revert «Home screen with colourful icon tiles» (requested by the administrator); journal phase 22 records the withdrawal
69d4d6a	2026-10-23	Teacher e-mail invitations: account approved by clicking the link
7f102e9	2026-10-24	Keep the student number column pinned beside the names while scrolling between days
71a6c3f	2026-10-24	Gmail app password: ignore spaces/line breaks; document SMTP_PASS name; journal phase 25
eb275cb	2026-10-24	Phone layout: days of the week stacked, navigate by scrolling down instead of sideways
4130252	2026-10-24	Day bar on the wide sheet; pinned number/name/phone columns also in French (LTR)
abde129	2026-10-24	الأسبوع الجاري للأستاذ والمطّلع دون تأثر بتنقّل المسؤول، ومنع التسجيل بعد نهاية الحصة، وإخفاء الشريط الضيق عند حافة الجدول
4c514fe	2026-10-24	إخفاء عمود الحذف؛ النقر على اسم التلميذ يتيح تعديل الاسم أو حذفه
6ca98b3	2026-10-24	حذف عمود خانات التحديد والحذف الجماعي، وتصحيح أعمدة صفّي أسفل الجدول
9bffafa	2026-10-24	توسيع خانات الغياب على الهاتف وتصغير عمود الاسم
b6aebb7	2026-10-24	نشر النسخة التدريبية على Vercel (ghiyab-training) وتوثيق ما بقي من إعدادها
d550872	2026-10-25	شريط أزرار الأيام يظهر أيضا في أسبوع العطلة البينية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 32)
4b2dc1c	2026-11-05	«مسؤول(ة)» بدل «مسؤول» في الواجهة والترجمة الفرنسية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 33)
b21d9ae	2026-11-05	زر «رسالة إلى ولي أمر» (واتساب) قبل «أرشفة الموسم» (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 34)

d276151	2026-11-05	مجموعات واتساب للأولياء (الأولى/الثانية/الثالثة إعدادي) في نافذة «رسالة إلى ولي أمر» (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 35)
0db9456	2026-11-05	أسماء مجموعات واتساب حسب المؤسسة (PARENT_GROUPS): بلا مجموعات في الابتدائي (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 36)
a843b29	2026-11-05	العطل البينية لموسم 2026/2027 من اللائحة الرسمية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 37)
7c6ae59	2026-11-05	ميزة «يوم عطلة»: أيام العطل المفردة (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 38)
15cfd6f	2026-11-06	تنقّل متسلسل بين الأسابيع وورقة الغياب الشهرية لتلميذ(ة) (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
4659edd	2026-11-06	ضبط تواريخ أسبوع الغياب دائما من الاثنين إلى الجمعة (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
c420e6e	2026-11-06	طباعة ورقة الغياب الأسبوعية على صفحة A4 أفقية واحدة (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
41a5e48	2026-11-06	توقيع الأساتذة وختم الإدارة في أسفل مطبوع الورقة الأسبوعية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
954c271	2026-11-06	توقيع الأستاذ(ة) تحت عمود كل حصة في مطبوع الورقة الأسبوعية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
e6e3162	2026-11-06	خانات سطر التوقيع أطول في مطبوع الورقة الأسبوعية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
13c32aa	2026-11-06	تظليل أسطر التلاميذ بالتناوب في مطبوع الورقة الأسبوعية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
7782060	2026-11-06	إعادة تصميم مطبوع الورقة الأسبوعية ليملأ صفحة A4 أفقية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
b37bd47	2026-11-06	مطبوع الورقة الأسبوعية: تضييق عمود الأسماء وحذف عمود «الجمعة مساء» (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 39)
be34943	2026-11-07	إصلاح استيراد «التنظيم التربوي» لملفات المدرسة الابتدائية (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 40)
9497cb3	2026-11-07	حماية غياب الأسابيع القديمة من الضياع عند حفظها بعد التنقل (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 41)
b054e87	2026-11-08	علامة أوضح وأسرع لطلبات الحسابات المعلّقة (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 42)
d9e6943	2026-11-08	تحيين الإحصائيات عند تغيير أسماء الأقسام وأداة حذف الغياب الخاطئ من الأرشيف (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 43)
8cc70d7	2026-11-08	زرّا «أعلى الصفحة» و«أسفل الصفحة» على الجانب الأيسر في نسخة الهاتف (سجل التطوير: المرحلة 44)
2546c13	2026-11-08	مظهر أكثر حيوية: عنوان بخط Lalezar وتدرّج ماجنتا←بنفسجي، وأزرار بخط Cairo وألوان زاهية متدرجة (فاتح/داكن)
1c6ad00	2026-11-08	عنوان التطبيق بلون أحمر أرجواني موحّد (دون تدرّج إلى البنفسجي)
c552845	2026-11-08	تبسيط ألوان الأزرار: أربعة ألوان بمعنى واحد لكل لون (أزرق عرض، بنفسجي إعدادات، أخضر تنفيذ، أحمر حذف)
643d7e3	2026-11-08	قائمة منسدلة «☰ القائمة» تجمع أقسام التطبيق في نسخة الحاسوب والهاتف
5ff7294	2026-11-08	نقل زر «☰ القائمة» ليصير أمام عنوان التطبيق مباشرة

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